

market behaviour and activity,” Maurya cautions.

GOLD

Gold prices soared near record highs in November, driven by dovish central bank policies and geopolitical tensions in the Middle East.

The yellow metal, as data shows, has exhibited significant growth over seven years, with its price rising from ₹29,461 on November 17, 2017, to ₹75,564 on November 19, 2024. This surge of around 156% highlights gold’s appeal as a hedge against inflation and market volatility (see table ‘Gold rise’).

However, there are headwinds. The US economy’s resilience has raised speculation that the Fed may slow rate cuts, pushing the dollar to around 104 and US 10-year Treasury yields above 4.2%. While escalating tensions between Israel and Iran could fuel further gains, a resolution to the conflict could limit gold’s upside potential.

As per Hareesh V., Head of Commodities at Geojit Financial Services, a combination of factors like escalating geopolitical tensions, low interest rates, and central bank demand has contributed to the rise in gold prices. “Gold has consistently provided returns, making it a perfect safe asset,” Hareesh says.

And what about next year?

Jateen Trivedi, VP Research Analyst–Commodity and Currency, LKP Securities, is of the opinion that the trend is likely to continue next year too. “Historically, prolonged conflicts tend to have a lasting impact on gold prices,” he says.

CRYPTOCURRENCY

In the last few days, the cryptocurrency market has surged remarkably, with total market capitalisation reaching a new all-time high of \$3.23 trillion as of November 19, 2024. Bitcoin has made headlines again, hitting an all-time high of \$92,041 with a year-to-date gain of

around 155%, pushing its total market capitalisation to \$1.82 trillion.

According to Shivam Thakral, CEO of crypto exchange BuyU-coin, the present excitement is fuelled by speculation surrounding pro-crypto regulatory changes in the US following recent election outcomes. “This bullish outlook is supported by Bitcoin’s dominance in the market and anticipated gains for other cryptocurrencies like Ethereum and Solana.”

REAL ESTATE

As per experts, India’s real estate market is thriving, with Bengaluru, Mumbai, and Delhi leading the way. Data from real estate firm Knight Frank shows that Bengaluru is on an upward trajectory as a tech hub, driving high office space absorption, including 4.3 million sq. ft by global capability centres.

On the residential side, the market has shown signs of stabilisation in Q3 2024 after years of growth, influenced by seasonal trends, rising prices, and evolving consumer preferences in major cities.

Commenting on these trends, Pavan Kumar, CEO and Founder of real estate firm White Lotus, says that differentiation in this sector has become more pronounced.

Over the past five years, average residential property prices across India’s top seven cities have increased steadily, with prices rising from ₹5,588 per sq. ft in 2019 to ₹8,390 per sq. ft in the first nine months of 2024. Experts say, as urbanisation intensifies, home prices would only go north.

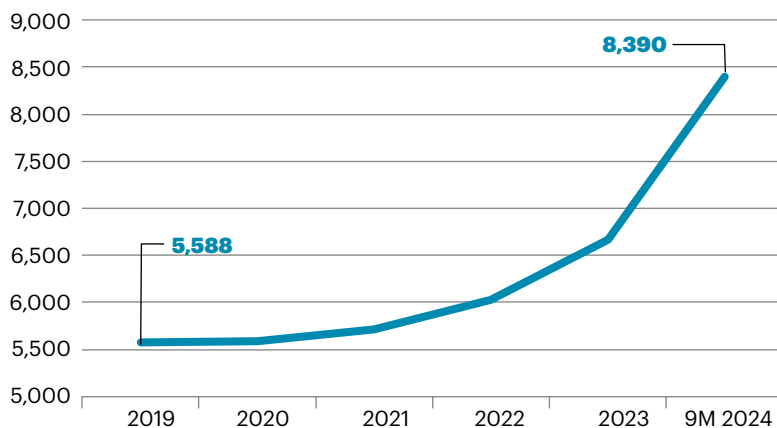
“The underlying fundamentals of the Indian economy remain strong, and the long-term prospects for the residential real estate sector remain positive,” opines Anuj Puri, Chairman of real estate research and services firm Anarock. **BT**

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Housing returns

● Property prices in the top cities rose from ₹5,588 per sq. ft to ₹8,390 per sq. ft in five years

● The 8.47% CAGR indicates strong demand and resilience in the real estate market



***AVERAGE OF TOP 7 CITIES** NCR, KOLKATA, MMR, PUNE, HYDERABAD, CHENNAI, AND BENGALURU **SOURCE** ANAROCK RESEARCH

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